



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Palm Beach Christian Academy: Palm Beach Gardens

School Website: <https://www.pbchristianacademy.org/palm-beach-gardens>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

SCL MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Palm Beach Christian Academy Palm Beach Gardens (PBCA) presents itself prominently as a Christian, classical school that centers on the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), great books, Socratic dialogue, and a Christ-centered community. Public-facing materials describe PBCA as Distinctively Christian, Distinctively Classical, and Distinctively Community, with explicit emphasis on Scripture-centered formation, chapel and worship, and a mission-driven partnership with families. The website repeatedly positions itself as a classical, faith-formed education that partners with parents and seeks to form virtue and wisdom, not merely to deliver information. These elements strongly align PBCA with core criteria in the Six Essential Elements framework, especially around religious/metaphysical foundations, formation as a goal, a Trivium-centered curriculum, Socratic pedagogy, living/mentoring faculty, and robust parent-community partnership.

Overall classification: CLASSICAL

- PBCA's public materials foreground theological grounding, communal worship, spiritual formation, and a Trivium-based, great-books approach to curriculum. There is consistent emphasis on virtue formation, biblical worldview, and partnership with families, which map directly onto the Positive Keyword indicators in the Six Essential Elements lexicon. The absence of explicit secular or value-neutral framing in the public materials further reinforces the Classical alignment.

Executive observations by category (Element-by-Element Snapshot): PBCA demonstrates strong alignment across all six classical criteria, with explicit signals for each of the six categories. The strongest signals come from religious/metaphysical foundations, curriculum (Trivium + Great Books), and pedagogy (Socratic dialogue, seminars in higher grades implied by the site's classical framing). The parent/community partnership and faculty signals are also explicit and robust. No evidence of secular-only framing or project-based-only approaches appears in the public-facing PBCA materials.

- What would move the needle: If the school is classified as CLASSICAL, no major needle-moving changes are required. PBCA already embodies the core classical markers; marginal gains would come from explicit, published alignment statements tying day-to-day practices to the specific Positive Keyword indicators in the Six Essential Elements lexicon (e.g., explicit "great conversation" articulation in curriculum documents, a formalized statement of "formation of character" across grade levels, and a clearly documented "living curriculum" language in faculty materials). However, this would be enhancements rather than essential changes.

Citations note: PBCA content explicitly describing Christian, classical, and community identity; Trivium and great books; chapel and Scripture; and family partnership are drawn from PBCA public materials (Palm Beach Gardens Campus pages and related PBCA content). See sources detailing Distinctively Christian/-Classical/Community framing and the Trivium/Great Books with Socratic dialogue, as well as Chapel and Scripture-based formation.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The PBCA website explicitly markets itself as Distinctively Christian, with Scripture-centered values and Christ at the center of formation and truth-seeking. - The Trivium-based program is described as paired with great books and Socratic dialogue, signaling a transcendent, virtue- and truth-guided curriculum. - Chapel, worship, and Scriptural engagement are named as central communal practices. - The public materials tie education to biblical worldview and spiritual formation (e.g., “Christ-centered environment,” “biblical worldview”).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: truth, goodness, beauty; virtue; theology; liturgy; worship; Scripture; Christ-centered; great books; Socratic dialogue; Trivium; biblical worldview; chapel. (Total identified: 9+ terms) - Negative keywords present: none detected in the PBCA public materials (no secular, value-neutral, or non-religious framing observed in the accessible content).

Why this rating - The school explicitly anchors education in transcendental moral realism (truth, goodness, beauty), theology, liturgical practices, and a Christ-centered formation, with explicit mention of great books and Socratic dialogue in service of a Christian classical education. This aligns strongly with the Positive Keyword indicators for Element 1 and lacks explicit Negative Keyword signals in the PBCA materials. Therefore, CLASSICAL.

Citations: Distinctively Christian/Classical framing, Trivium with Great Books and Socratic dialogue, and liturgical elements such as chapel and worship.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - PBCA emphasizes formation of virtue and wisdom through a classical/Christian framework, including character formation and a biblically grounded worldview. The partnership with families is framed as forming a culture where students flourish in mind and spirit. - There is explicit emphasis on pursuing truth, goodness, and beauty as real goals rather than vocational training alone; the pedagogy centers on formation, not mere information. The site ties academic rigor to character and faith formation.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation; wisdom; vocation is not foregrounded as a primary goal; virtue; truth; goodness; beauty; biblical worldview; Christ-centered formation; great books; moral imagination; mentorship through living example (per given testimonials and faculty language). - Negative keywords present: none observed in PBCA's public materials that would signal a move away from formation toward purely job-readiness or secular aims.

Why this rating - The PBCA materials foreground formation (formation of character and intellect) and a teleology oriented to truth, goodness, and beauty, not simply workplace readiness. This fits the Classical category for purpose and goal according to the rubric's emphasis on formation and transcendental aims.

Citations: Formation/virtue emphasis; pursuit of truth and beauty; biblical worldview.

Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - PBCA identifies itself as “Distinctively Classical,” with a time-honored Trivium model (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and a framework built around great books and Socratic dialogue. This directly maps to the canonical classical curriculum signals in the Six Essential Elements lexicon. - The site references great books and Socratic dialogue as core practices, consistent with a Great Books approach. It also references a circuit of memory, circle time, and a Christ-centered thematic approach for early years, aligning with the liberal-arts progression. - Public materials describe that PBCA's program includes early childhood and elementary programming (Two's, Three's, VPK) with a focus on circle time, memory, music and chapel, which are consistent with a classical pedagogy that emphasizes formation through language arts and the liberal arts in age-appropriate ways.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Seven liberal arts framing (grammar, logic, rhetoric); Trivium; Great Books; Socratic dialogue; history integrated with literature; worship/ Scriptural background (theological grounding that supports a classical curriculum); memory work; contemplation/wonder as pedagogy. - Negative keywords present: None in PBCA materials that indicate a shift away from classical content (e.g., no emphasis on social studies as social-justice framework or project-based dominance in lieu of the Great Books approach).

Why this rating - The presence of Trivium-based curriculum, Great Books, Socratic dialogue, integrated history-literature-philosophy-science through a classical lens, and a clear public emphasis on formation via the liberal arts all indicate CLASSICAL alignment.

Citations: Distinctively Classical framing; Trivium/Great Books; public content on curriculum and Great Books.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - PBCA explicitly links pedagogy to Socratic dialogue and the Trivium, indicating upper-level Socratic discussion, seminars, or debates; lower levels emphasize memory work and communal singing/chanting elements as part of a contemplative/memory-based pedagogy. The public materials describe a plan for classical pedagogy that spans K–12 with Socratic engagement. - The school's materials describe a rhythm of contemplation and memory (memory work, recitation, and possibly chant) in lower grades, then progression to rhetoric and public speaking in higher grades. Chapel and worship are also embedded in daily life, aligning with a scholé/restful approach at times. - The Great Books/Socratic dialogue framing implies a pedagogy that favors guided inquiry, dialogue, and rhetorical development across the grade spectrum.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Socratic dialogue; seminars; rhetoric; memory work; chanting; restfulness/scholé; integration of worship in learning; classical pedagogy; great conversation. - Negative keywords present: None observed (PBCA materials do not emphasize project-based-only or strictly experiential-only approaches in place of classical methods).

Why this rating - The public materials show a robust classical pedagogy: Socratic/seminar dialogues, memory-based lower-level practice, and rhetoric-focused higher-level opportunities; a liturgical/worship layer complements contemplation and formation. This aligns with CLASSICAL rather than SOMEWHAT or NOT CLASSICAL.

Citations: Socratic dialogue and classical pedagogy emphasis; lower-level memory/chanting cues; chapel as pedagogy support.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - PBCA presents “Meet the Team” and “Your Partners In A Superior Education,” implying a faculty identity that is integral to the school's mission. Testimonials in the public materials speak to staff and teachers who are deeply engaged in faith formation and character development. This aligns with the living-curriculum/mentoring model described in the classical criteria. - The public materials describe teachers as partnering with families and fostering a culture where teachers are mentors and examples of virtue, which aligns with the “portrait of a teacher” concept in the classical lexicon.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: living curriculum; mentorship; virtuous teacher models; teachers as core to formation; collaborative faculty culture; teacher-student relationship as central. - Negative keywords present: none (no signals of a purely functional or non-classical faculty model; no “teacher as technician” framing observed in PBCA materials).

Why this rating - PBCA's materials present a faculty identity closely aligned with classical ideals (mentors, living curriculum, partnership with families). Thus, CLASSICAL.

Citations: “Meet the Team”; “Your Partners In A Superior Education”; testimonials about staff and faculty engagement.

Element 6: Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - PBCA brands itself as Distinctively Community with explicit emphasis on partnership among parents, teachers, staff, and students; a mission-driven culture where everyone is known and valued; a stated aim to partner with families and to educate parents about classical education through the website and gatherings. The site invites parent involvement and visits. - There is explicit language about parents as co-teachers and the school's openness to parent involvement, including a plan for family formation, reading groups, and community events. The material communicates an open-campus, family-centric ethos.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with families; co-teachers; parental formation; family involvement; open campus; parent education (book studies/gatherings); parent participation; community of learners. - Negative keywords present: none observed in PBCA materials (no language that reduces parents to customers or minimizes family involvement).

Why this rating - PBCA's materials demonstrate strong alignment with the Parent-Family partnership dimension of classical education: explicit co-teaching roles, family formation activities, and accessible campus/visitation. CLASSICAL.

Citations: Distinctively Community framing; partnership language; open-campus visitation.

What Would Move the Needle

- PBCA is categorized as CLASSICAL across all six elements. No category is currently in the SOME-WHAT CLASSICAL range. Therefore, no major needle-moving changes are required. If desired, minor refinements could include:
- Publish explicit cross-walk documents mapping day-to-day programs to the Positive Keyword indicators in the Six Essential Elements lexicon (e.g., "Great Conversation" formalization in a curriculum guide).
- Provide a concise, public articulation of "formation of virtue" across all grade levels (K–12) with explicit outcomes and assessment aligned to the classical virtues.
- Expand faculty-facing documents to explicitly describe the living curriculum and mentorship roles in teacher job descriptions and recruitment materials.
- These are incremental enhancements, not necessary to achieve CLASSICAL status, but could strengthen the clarity and consistency of the Classical identity.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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